

Next Steps — Weather School Launch

Updated June 12, 2026 (overnight build session). Items marked ■ are things Claude does — just say the word. Everything else needs you.

1. Quick reviews (5 minutes, do first)

- **Look at both sites** (open `sites/canes/index.html` and `sites/earthsphere/index.html`). Overnight changes: official Cane art on every class card, your 8 backgrounds worked into the Cane site, and the EarthSphere hero is now the spinning Earth with blue atmosphere on a starfield, as you specced.
- **Official logo — DONE June 12.** Found your saved file, cropped it, made the background transparent, and placed it in the site header.
- **Cane lock retraining:** I curated your 19 on-model images into `assets/cane-refs/` and started the retrain, but the request timed out before fal confirmed. ■ Next session, tell me "retrain Cane and regenerate the off-model cards" — only the Volcanoes and Ocean cards (January classes) still show the wrong dog.

2. Accounts to set up (the go-live plumbing — roughly an evening)

- **Neon.tech** (free tier) — create a project, copy the connection string. ■ I run the seed script.
- **Netlify** — two sites from the one codebase; point `canesweatherschool.com` and `earthsphereacademy.com` at them. ■ I provide every env var (they're listed in `netlify.toml`).
- **Shopify — DONE June 12.** All 19 class products are in your `CaneTheWeatherDog` store as **drafts** with prices, descriptions, and SKUs, and the enroll buttons on both sites are already wired to them. Your part: review the drafts, then flip the fall classes to Active when ready to sell. Still needed: add an `orders/paid` webhook (Settings → Notifications → Webhooks) pointing at <https://canesweatherschool.com/api/shopify-webhook> once Netlify is live.
- **Bunny.net** — create a Stream library with token authentication; copy the library ID + token key into Netlify env vars.
- **Resend.com** (or Postmark) — transactional email for access codes; verify your sending domain.
- **Mailchimp or Kit** — wire the lead-magnet form on the EarthSphere homepage; the 5-email welcome sequence is already written (`Academy-Email-Welcome-Sequence.md`).
- **Social handles** — register `@earthsphereacademy` and `@canesweatherschool` on IG, TikTok, YouTube, Facebook, X before someone else does.
- **USPTO TESS search** on "EarthSphere" (15 minutes; do before spending on branding).

3. Decisions only you can make

- **Final pricing** — placeholders live: Cane's \$59–\$99, EarthSphere \$149–\$199. Change anytime in the admin panel, no code.

- **Confirm the fall catalog cut** — currently: Cane's fall = Storms 101, Hurricane Hunters, Weather Academy; EarthSphere fall = Meteorology Sem 1, Weather Detectives, Weather & Climate (7–8), Severe Weather & Forecasting. Everything else says "Coming January."
- **Confirm Sept 2 start date** and **Weather Detectives as the graduation-gift class** (both are set as defaults).
- **Approve the Weather Academy 4-week arc** (flagged in your master index as my proposed sequence).
- **Verify NGSS codes** against your state's standards before printing teacher-facing materials.

4. Content production (your Mon/Tue blocks, July–August)

- **Record Lesson 1 of each fall class by Sept 2** — that's all the drip model requires for launch day: 4 EarthSphere lessons + 3 Cane's lessons. EarthSphere first (higher price, transcript deadlines).
- Then stay **2–3 lessons ahead** of the weekly release calendar all semester.
- Upload each video to Bunny, paste its ID into the lesson in the admin panel — that's the whole publish flow.
- ■ I can draft every study guide, flash-card deck, and quiz from your existing lesson plans and load them into the app — say "build the companion content."

5. What's already done (don't redo)

Platform code (backend, both sites, both PWA apps, admin panel), database schema, catalog matching your blueprint docs, access-code/drip/discount/graduation automations, all art mapped from your approved files, and 22/22 tests passing.

The critical path is Section 2. Everything else can move while accounts get created.